

UNIVERSITY OF PUNE Pune

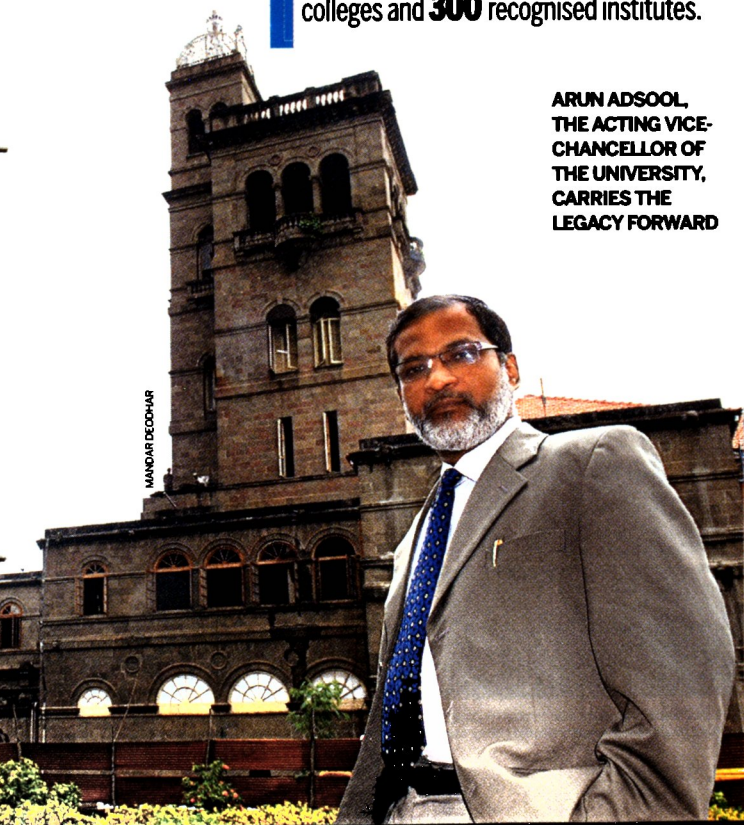
MINDS AT WORK

One of the largest traditional universities in the world, with 6,50,000 students, 536 colleges and 332 recognised institutes, excluding medical colleges, the University of Pune is known as the Oxford of the East. But former vice-chancellor (v-c) Narendra Jadhav, who has just left to come to the Planning Commission, was not interested in living off past laurels. "There is no point in criticising the system from outside. It's more important to fight from within," says the economist who was with the Reserve Bank of India for 31 years. Within three years, he undertook whirlwind changes, rewriting 484 curricula (222 are already done), offering Rs 8 crore a year to all colleges for research projects ranging from Rs 50,000 to Rs 3 lakh, and bringing about a connect with society. Through the latter, he set aside a Rs 5 crore budget for the earn and learn scheme started by Karmaveer Bhaurao Patil; spent Rs 3.66 crore on personality development centres in over 200 colleges and most significantly, started the Samarth Bharat Abhiyan, where colleges adopted 487 villages in Maharashtra. With a senior citizen's centre and work in progress on restoring the 155-year-old Governor's residence where Winston Churchill once stayed, the 400-acre campus is well on the way to celebrating 60 years of its existence next year. "The university has changed from being a centre of preaching to teaching and finally, to becoming a respected centre of learning for all its students," says Arun Adsool, acting v-c.

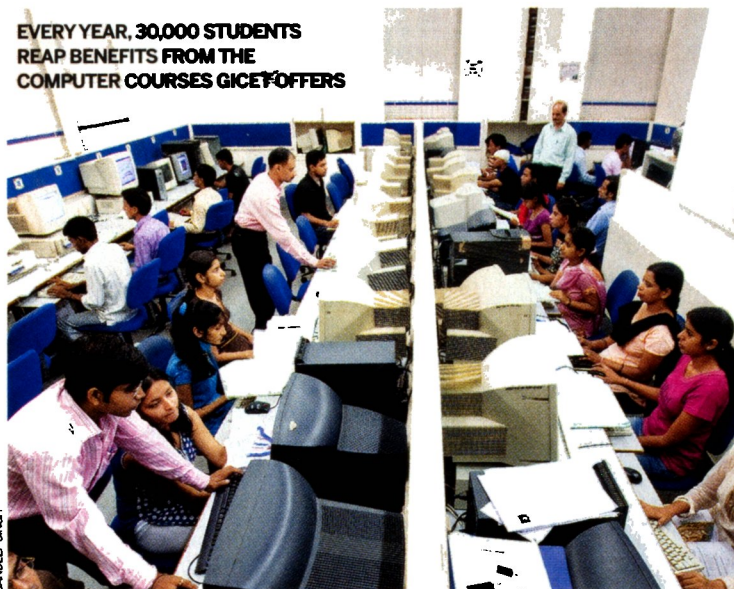
by Swati Mathur

The University has over **500** affiliated colleges and **300** recognised institutes.

ARUN ADSOOL,
THE ACTING VICE-
CHANCELLOR OF
THE UNIVERSITY,
CARRIES THE
LEGACY FORWARD



EVERY YEAR, 30,000 STUDENTS
REAP BENEFITS FROM THE
COMPUTER COURSES GICET OFFERS



BHARATIYA VIDYA BHAVAN Across the Country

READY FOR THE JOBS

For Manoj Bahri, a 42-year-old autorickshaw driver from Delhi, it's a dream come true that his son not only got through the Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's (BVB) Gandhi Institute of Computer Education and Training (GICET), but now works as a clerk at a salary of Rs 10,000 per month. Founded in 1938 by nationalist leader K.M. Munshi, who was governor of Uttar Pradesh from 1952-57, BVB has grown from a modest institution into a cultural and educational movement with 112 kendras in India and eight overseas centres. In 1995, when environmentalist and writer Hogen Fukanga, who is the chairman of Earth Aid-Japan, received the Mahatma Gandhi Peace Award, he donated the entire amount of \$1 lakh to BVB. This money was used for the conception of GICET with an aim to make weaker sections of the society computer-literate, so they stand a better chance of securing placements in the form of office assistants or basic Java programmers. What is remarkable is that the institute, with 32 centres across India, strives to achieve this by providing training and study material completely free of cost. The three-month-long course was specially designed by BVB's educational adviser M.P. Navalkar. The response to the course has been phenomenal, with approximately 30,000 students graduating every year. Besides imparting computer skills, the students are also given tips on personality development for brighter career prospects.

by Gunjeet Sra

BVB's success can be gauged from the fact that today it has **112** kendras in India and eight overseas centres.